

MEAL PREP PLAN

White Beans & Sweet Potato Base + Protein

Base Configuration:

- 200g white beans + sweet potato per meal
- 250-300g frozen protein (salmon, white fish, or chicken breast)
- Cooked fresh each morning in ~15-20 minutes
- All components frozen separately for flexibility

SHOPPING LIST

ITEM	QTY	NOTES
White beans (frozen)	1 kg bag	Approximately 10-12 portions
Sweet potato	1.2 kg	Medium-sized (6-8 pieces)
Garlic	1 bulb	Fresh, 4-5 cloves
Onion	1 large	Yellow onion preferred
Olive oil	500 ml	Extra virgin for cooking
Sea salt & black pepper	as needed	To taste
PROTEINS (Choose at least 2):		
Salmon fillets (frozen)	800g-1kg	10-12 portions @ 80-90g each
White fish (frozen)	800g-1kg	Tilapia, sea bass, or similar
Chicken breast (frozen)	800g-1kg	Diced or whole breasts

PREPARATION (Friday - 90 minutes)

STEP 1: Prepare Vegetables (30 min)

1. Peel and cube sweet potato into 1.5cm cubes (approximately 1.2 kg → ~1.5 liters chopped)
2. Dice onion finely
3. Mince garlic (4-5 cloves)

STEP 2: Cook Base (40 min)

1. Heat 2 tablespoons olive oil in large pot over medium heat
2. Add diced onion + minced garlic, sauté 3-4 minutes until fragrant
3. Add 1 kg frozen white beans (no need to thaw)
4. Add cubed sweet potato
5. Add 300 ml water
6. Season with 1 teaspoon sea salt + ½ teaspoon black pepper
7. Bring to boil, then reduce to low-medium heat
8. Simmer 35-40 minutes until sweet potato is very soft and beans are heated through
9. Stir occasionally to prevent sticking

STEP 3: Cool & Portion (20 min)

1. Spread cooked mixture on large flat tray to cool to room temperature (important!)
2. Once cool (~15 min), divide into 10-12 portions of 200g each using a scale

3. Place each 200g portion in labeled freezer bag
4. Label with date and "Beans & Sweet Potato Base"
5. Freeze flat (stacks nicely this way)

■ ■ PROTEIN PREPARATION

General Notes:

- Keep proteins frozen until morning of cooking
- Each portion = 80-90g (slightly less due to shrinkage during cooking)
- All proteins cook in 12-15 minutes with base from frozen

SALMON (If chosen):

- Buy: 800-1000g frozen salmon fillets
- Portion: 85-90g per freezer bag (10-12 bags)
- Cooking: Thaw 5 min in warm water, then pan-fry 10-12 min with 1 tsp oil on medium-high
- Doneness: Flakes easily with fork, no translucent center

WHITE FISH (Tilapia, sea bass, or similar - If chosen):

- Buy: 800-1000g frozen white fish fillets
- Portion: 85-90g per freezer bag (10-12 bags)
- Cooking: Thaw 5 min in warm water, then pan-fry 8-10 min with 1 tsp oil on medium heat
- Doneness: Flesh is opaque throughout, flakes with gentle pressure

CHICKEN BREAST (If chosen):

- Buy: 800-1000g frozen chicken breast (diced or whole)
- Portion: 90-100g per freezer bag (10-12 bags) — chicken shrinks more than fish
- Cooking: Thaw 5 min in warm water, dice if whole, pan-fry 12-15 min with 1 tsp oil on medium-high
- Doneness: No pink inside, reaches 74°C internal temperature (if using thermometer)

■■ MORNING COOKING ROUTINE (at work - 15-20 min)

You have 3 options each morning:

OPTION 1: Salmon + Beans & Sweet Potato Base

1. 08:00 → Remove 200g beans base + 85g salmon from freezer
2. 08:05 → Heat small pan on stove, add 1 tsp oil
3. 08:07 → Add salmon (still frozen or lightly thawed), cook 10-12 min on medium-high
4. 08:10 → Warm beans base in separate small pot or microwave (2-3 min if microwave, 5-7 min if stovetop)
5. 08:20 → Plate together and serve warm

OPTION 2: White Fish + Beans & Sweet Potato Base

1. 08:00 → Remove 200g beans base + 85g white fish from freezer
2. 08:05 → Heat small pan on stove, add 1 tsp oil
3. 08:07 → Add white fish (still frozen), cook 8-10 min on medium heat
4. 08:10 → Warm beans base in separate small pot or microwave
5. 08:18 → Plate together and serve warm

OPTION 3: Chicken Breast + Beans & Sweet Potato Base

1. 08:00 → Remove 200g beans base + 100g chicken from freezer
2. 08:05 → Heat small pan on stove, add 1 tsp oil
3. 08:07 → Add chicken (diced if whole), cook 12-15 min on medium-high until no pink
4. 08:10 → Warm beans base in separate small pot or microwave
5. 08:22 → Plate together and serve warm

Nutritional Profile (Approximate per meal):

- Calories: 380-420 kcal
- Protein: 35-40g
- Carbs: 32-35g (low GI)
- Fat: 8-10g
- Fiber: 6-8g

❄■■ STORAGE & TIPS

Freezer Storage:

- Beans & sweet potato base: Up to 3 months (sealed bags, no air)
- Proteins: Check manufacturer's freezing guidelines (typically 2-3 months for frozen fish/chicken)
- Label all bags with date and contents

Pro Tips:

- Always cool base fully before freezing (condensation → ice crystals)
- Freeze proteins in individual portions for maximum flexibility
- Thaw proteins gently in warm water (5 min) rather than room temperature for food safety
- Cook protein in separate pan from base for better texture control
- Beans base reheats beautifully — no quality loss
- This system works Monday-Friday perfectly for your work schedule at Harel

Substitutions:

- Low on sweet potato? Use 600g potato + 600g white beans (same GI profile)
- Prefer sea bass over tilapia? Works identically — adjust cooking time by ± 1 min
- Add 1 tbsp soy sauce to bean base for umami depth (optional)